

Artie Ficial

Your grievance with Grant

Grant had privately informed you that tonight's gift would come with a new governance agreement: he wanted veto power over acquisitions, his name on the museum, and your resignation within sixty days. You smiled through the meeting and told no one.

Your other secret

You have already accepted a confidential offer to lead a rival museum next year, which makes any argument with Grant look like succession planning.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Find out whether Monet has seen the governance addendum.
3. Quietly learn whether Claire would stay if you left.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant wanted his name on the building and me out of the director's chair. Apparently the gift included a complimentary replacement director. I was furious. I did not agree to resign.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I was at the museum office from 6:40 to 6:49, dealing with a confidential job offer from a rival museum. The museum attendant there watched me throughout. I did not go back to the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

From 6:40 to 6:49, I was at the museum office. I was dealing with a confidential job offer from a rival museum. I did not return to the Donor Salon during that time.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card B; animal CALLED = Card A. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The signed record confirms the attendant watched me at the museum office throughout the whole window. It also exposes a confidential job offer from a rival museum. I would rather be embarrassed than accused of murder.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

I stand by my account of being at the museum office. I dispute the service attendant's identification. I cannot produce a continuous alibi record. Please compare the time on that note with the poison window before deciding.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.

Claire O'Scuro

Your grievance with Grant

You discovered that Grant knew the Star Bowl's provenance file contained a major gap and ordered the exhibition to proceed anyway. He threatened to remove you from the show if you raised the issue publicly.

Your other secret

Against board instructions, you commissioned an independent provenance review and hid the preliminary report in the Registrar's Office.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Find out whether Art has seen the same gap you found.
3. Learn who wrote the anonymous warning note.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant wanted me to approve a provenance file with a decade missing. I refused to make a missing decade sound like a charming gap year. He threatened to remove me from the exhibition.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I was at the Registrar's scanning desk from 6:40 to 6:49, dealing with an unauthorized independent provenance review. The museum attendant there watched me throughout. I did not go back to the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

From 6:40 to 6:49, I was at the Registrar's scanning desk. I was dealing with an unauthorized independent provenance review. I did not return to the Donor Salon during that time.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card A; animal CALLED = Card B. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The signed record confirms the attendant watched me at the Registrar's scanning desk throughout the whole window. It also exposes an unauthorized independent provenance review. I would rather be embarrassed than accused of murder.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

I stand by my account of being at the Registrar's scanning desk. I dispute the service attendant's identification. I cannot produce a continuous alibi record. Please compare the time on that note with the poison window before deciding.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.

Hugh Bidder

Your grievance with Grant

Grant had learned that one certificate in a major private sale you brokered was forged before it ever reached you. He planned to imply publicly that you had created it unless you refunded him millions.

Your other secret

You were duped on that sale, but you quietly altered your own file afterward so clients would not see how badly your due diligence failed.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Learn whether Saul knows about the disputed certificate.
3. Keep Elon from discussing the 'auction incident' in public.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant threatened to blame me for a forged certificate and demand millions back. I did not forge it. My paperwork afterward was less impeccable than my jacket.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I was at the Media Room document terminal from 6:40 to 6:49, dealing with the sale file I altered after discovering the forged certificate. The museum attendant there watched me throughout. I did not go back to the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

From 6:40 to 6:49, I was at the Media Room document terminal. I was dealing with the sale file I altered after discovering the forged certificate. I did not return to the Donor Salon during that time.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card B; animal CALLED = Card A. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The signed record confirms the attendant watched me at the Media Room document terminal throughout the whole window. It also exposes the sale file I altered after discovering the forged certificate. I would rather be embarrassed than accused of murder.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

I stand by my account of being at the Media Room document terminal. I dispute the service attendant's identification. I cannot produce a continuous alibi record. Please compare the time on that note with the poison window before deciding.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.

Monet Bags

Your grievance with Grant

Grant demanded that you disguise several gala and naming-wing expenses inside restricted museum funds until his promised donation cleared. When you resisted, he threatened to blame the bookkeeping on you.

Your other secret

You temporarily moved money between internal accounts to cover a cash-flow shortfall, intending to reverse it after the gala. It was technically unauthorized and Grant discovered it.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Find out whether Sue has seen Grant's draft funding agreement.
3. Keep Artie from learning about the temporary transfer unless absolutely necessary.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant wanted to inspect a transfer I had made without board approval. The money was not stolen, but the authorization was missing. He was preparing to make me the evening's second exhibit.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I was at the finance office from 6:40 to 6:49, dealing with an unauthorized internal transfer. The museum attendant there watched me throughout. I did not go back to the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

From 6:40 to 6:49, I was at the finance office. I was dealing with an unauthorized internal transfer. I did not return to the Donor Salon during that time.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card B; animal CALLED = Card A. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The signed record confirms the attendant watched me at the finance office throughout the whole window. It also exposes an unauthorized internal transfer. I would rather be embarrassed than accused of murder.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

I stand by my account of being at the finance office. I dispute the service attendant's identification. I cannot produce a continuous alibi record. Please compare the time on that note with the poison window before deciding.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.

Chip Patina

Your grievance with Grant

Grant pressured you to soften a conservation report showing that one supposedly untouched object had been recently altered. He threatened to replace you with a private conservator if you refused.

Your other secret

You changed the date on a minor treatment record last month to spare the museum an embarrassing insurance dispute. No object was harmed, but the falsification could end your career.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Find out whether Cary has noticed the altered treatment date.
3. Ask Art what he thinks the Star Bowl's modern adhesive means.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant pressured me to soften a conservation report. I had also changed a treatment date. I wanted both facts kept quiet. Conservators are supposed to preserve things, including their careers.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I was at the Conservation Lab from 6:40 to 6:49, dealing with the treatment record whose date I changed. The museum attendant there watched me throughout. I did not go back to the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

From 6:40 to 6:49, I was at the Conservation Lab. I was dealing with the treatment record whose date I changed. I did not return to the Donor Salon during that time.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card A; animal CALLED = Card B. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The signed record confirms the attendant watched me at the Conservation Lab throughout the whole window. It also exposes the treatment record whose date I changed. I would rather be embarrassed than accused of murder.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

I stand by my account of being at the Conservation Lab. I dispute the service attendant's identification. I cannot produce a continuous alibi record. Please compare the time on that note with the poison window before deciding.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.

Dada DiCapo

Your grievance with Grant

Grant appropriated the concept for one of your unreleased performances and planned to unveil a sanitized version of it as the gala's closing spectacle, crediting himself as creative patron.

Your other secret

You wrote and planted the ominous anonymous warning note about 'returning what was taken.' It was meant as an art-world provocation, not a literal threat.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Enjoy watching people overreact to your warning note without admitting you wrote it.
3. Find out whether Minnie changed the lighting cue you designed.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant stole the concept for my performance and credited his foundation. My work was about appropriation. He apparently thought that was an instruction.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I was at the Media Room print counter from 6:40 to 6:49, dealing with copies of the warning note I planted for my performance. The museum attendant there watched me throughout. I did not go back to the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

From 6:40 to 6:49, I was at the Media Room print counter. I was dealing with copies of the warning note I planted for my performance. I did not return to the Donor Salon during that time.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card B; animal CALLED = Card A. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The signed record confirms the attendant watched me at the Media Room print counter throughout the whole window. It also exposes copies of the warning note I planted for my performance. I would rather be embarrassed than accused of murder.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

I stand by my account of being at the Media Room print counter. I dispute the service attendant's identification. I cannot produce a continuous alibi record. Please compare the time on that note with the poison window before deciding.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.

Vincent Van Faux

Your grievance with Grant

Grant owned an embarrassing student painting you have spent years trying to buy back. He planned to display it tonight beside your celebrated recent work as a joke about 'humble beginnings.'

Your other secret

You have secretly used buyers to acquire several of your own early paintings so you could remove them from circulation. The art world would find that both vain and market-manipulative.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Find out whether Ella knows you were behind the anonymous buybacks.
3. Persuade Claire that the student painting should not be displayed.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant planned to display an embarrassing student painting beside my latest work. It was not a retrospective. It was a hostage situation with a frame.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I was at the Registrar's copier from 6:40 to 6:49, dealing with proxy paperwork for buying back my own early paintings. The museum attendant there watched me throughout. I did not go back to the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

From 6:40 to 6:49, I was at the Registrar's copier. I was dealing with proxy paperwork for buying back my own early paintings. I did not return to the Donor Salon during that time.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card A; animal CALLED = Card B. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The signed record confirms the attendant watched me at the Registrar's copier throughout the whole window. It also exposes proxy paperwork for buying back my own early paintings. I would rather be embarrassed than accused of murder.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

I stand by my account of being at the Registrar's copier. I dispute the service attendant's identification. I cannot produce a continuous alibi record. Please compare the time on that note with the poison window before deciding.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.

Sue Venir

Your grievance with Grant

You wrote a private legal memorandum concluding that the Star Bowl's acquisition was too risky to defend confidently. Grant forced you to replace it with a softer opinion and planned to cite your name during the announcement.

Your other secret

Both versions of the memo still exist. You kept the original instead of destroying it, which could expose you to professional embarrassment and Grant to serious scrutiny.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Learn whether Mona has obtained a copy of your original memo.
3. Keep Art from publicly speculating about your legal advice.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant wanted me to make a dubious ownership claim sound legally clean. I had already softened one memo under pressure. I was trying to recover the original version.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I was at the Registrar's secure print desk from 6:40 to 6:49, dealing with the original legal memo I was pressured to soften. The museum attendant there watched me throughout. I did not go back to the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

From 6:40 to 6:49, I was at the Registrar's secure print desk. I was dealing with the original legal memo I was pressured to soften. I did not return to the Donor Salon during that time.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card A; animal CALLED = Card B. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The signed record confirms the attendant watched me at the Registrar's secure print desk throughout the whole window. It also exposes the original legal memo I was pressured to soften. I would rather be embarrassed than accused of murder.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

I stand by my account of being at the Registrar's secure print desk. I dispute the service attendant's identification. I cannot produce a continuous alibi record. Please compare the time on that note with the poison window before deciding.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.

Dr. Art E. Fact

Your grievance with Grant

Grant suppressed your research showing that two objects in his collection passed through a dealer linked to questionable wartime sales. He threatened to release correspondence suggesting you had overstated another provenance claim if you challenged him publicly.

Your other secret

One celebrated article of yours does contain an inference you stated too confidently. The main thesis still stands, but the mistake would be humiliating.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Ask Reed what he has discovered in the accession records.
3. Determine whether Claire commissioned outside provenance research.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant threatened to expose an error in my best-known article. I would have preferred a discreet correction. He preferred a microphone and an audience.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I was at the Media Room archive scanner from 6:40 to 6:49, dealing with correspondence showing the mistake in my published article. The museum attendant there watched me throughout. I did not go back to the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

From 6:40 to 6:49, I was at the Media Room archive scanner. I was dealing with correspondence showing the mistake in my published article. I did not return to the Donor Salon during that time.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card B; animal CALLED = Card A. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The signed record confirms the attendant watched me at the Media Room archive scanner throughout the whole window. It also exposes correspondence showing the mistake in my published article. I would rather be embarrassed than accused of murder.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

I stand by my account of being at the Media Room archive scanner. I dispute the service attendant's identification. I cannot produce a continuous alibi record. Please compare the time on that note with the poison window before deciding.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.

Tess Tament

Your grievance with Grant

Grant told you he intended to rewrite the family trust tonight, removing you from control of the charitable foundation unless you publicly backed his museum naming plan.

Your other secret

You have been quietly organizing other family trustees to block Grant's control over the foundation and redirect future giving toward worker and community programs.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Find out whether Anya would publicly oppose renaming the museum.
3. Gauge Artie's willingness to reject Grant's conditions.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant threatened my inheritance if I supported the other trustees against him. I was copying the trust documents. A family disagreement, yes. Not a murder plan.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I was at the donor-office document desk from 6:40 to 6:49, dealing with trust documents for the family challenge. The museum attendant there watched me throughout. I did not go back to the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

From 6:40 to 6:49, I was at the donor-office document desk. I was dealing with trust documents for the family challenge. I did not return to the Donor Salon during that time.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card A; animal CALLED = Card B. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The signed record confirms the attendant watched me at the donor-office document desk throughout the whole window. It also exposes trust documents for the family challenge. I would rather be embarrassed than accused of murder.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

I stand by my account of being at the donor-office document desk. I dispute the service attendant's identification. I cannot produce a continuous alibi record. Please compare the time on that note with the poison window before deciding.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.

Barb Dwyer

Your grievance with Grant

Grant ordered you to disable the Donor Salon camera because he planned several off-the-record meetings. He then told you that if anything went wrong tonight, security would 'own the failure.'

Your other secret

You personally unplugged the camera despite museum policy. You did it under direct donor pressure and never documented the order.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Find out who knew the Donor Salon camera was offline.
3. Keep the camera decision quiet until you understand the murder timeline.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant ordered me to switch off the salon camera. I complied against policy. He then suggested I would take the blame if anything went wrong. Something has certainly gone wrong.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I was at the security station from 6:40 to 6:49, dealing with manual security checks after disabling the camera. The museum attendant there watched me throughout. I did not go back to the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

From 6:40 to 6:49, I was at the security station. I was dealing with manual security checks after disabling the camera. I did not return to the Donor Salon during that time.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card B; animal CALLED = Card A. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The signed record confirms the attendant watched me at the security station throughout the whole window. It also exposes manual security checks after disabling the camera. I would rather be embarrassed than accused of murder.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

I stand by my account of being at the security station. I dispute the service attendant's identification. I cannot produce a continuous alibi record. Please compare the time on that note with the poison window before deciding.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.

Paige Turner

Your grievance with Grant

You were preparing a major investigation into Grant's collection and labor empire. He discovered enough to threaten an injunction and promised to reveal the identity of one of your confidential museum sources if you published.

Your other secret

You obtained internal documents through a source inside the Meridian. Protecting that source matters more to you than tonight's scoop.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Find out whether Grant found the full provenance spreadsheet or only excerpts.
3. Keep your source's identity protected.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant threatened to bury my investigation and ruin my access to sources. I had the documents for a story scheduled tonight. I wanted him answering questions, not dead.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I was at the Press Room scanner from 6:40 to 6:49, dealing with source documents behind my embargoed story. The museum attendant there watched me throughout. I did not go back to the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

From 6:40 to 6:49, I was at the Press Room scanner. I was dealing with source documents behind my embargoed story. I did not return to the Donor Salon during that time.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card A; animal CALLED = Card B. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The signed record confirms the attendant watched me at the Press Room scanner throughout the whole window. It also exposes source documents behind my embargoed story. I would rather be embarrassed than accused of murder.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

I stand by my account of being at the Press Room scanner. I dispute the service attendant's identification. I cannot produce a continuous alibi record. Please compare the time on that note with the poison window before deciding.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.

Frank Lloyd Wrong

Your grievance with Grant

Grant demanded a dangerous last-minute change to the centerpiece display and threatened to withhold your firm's final payment if you refused. He also planned to blame you publicly for any flaw in the opening-night presentation.

Your other secret

You signed off on one temporary lighting rig that did not fully meet your own design standard because there was no time to rebuild it before the gala.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Keep Chip from turning the temporary rig into a formal safety dispute.
3. Find out what Minnie changed after your final walkthrough.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant threatened to withhold my final payment unless I changed the display. I had approved a temporary rig I should not have approved. My reputation was balancing on it.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I was at the Grand Gallery lighting console from 6:40 to 6:49, dealing with adjustments to an unapproved temporary lighting rig. The museum attendant there watched me throughout. I did not go back to the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

From 6:40 to 6:49, I was at the Grand Gallery lighting console. I was dealing with adjustments to an unapproved temporary lighting rig. I did not return to the Donor Salon during that time.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card B; animal CALLED = Card A. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The signed record confirms the attendant watched me at the Grand Gallery lighting console throughout the whole window. It also exposes adjustments to an unapproved temporary lighting rig. I would rather be embarrassed than accused of murder.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

I stand by my account of being at the Grand Gallery lighting console. I dispute the service attendant's identification. I cannot produce a continuous alibi record. Please compare the time on that note with the poison window before deciding.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.

Mona Lott

Your grievance with Grant

Grant intended to announce that the Star Bowl would become a permanent Meridian holding, undermining months of quiet restitution negotiations and publicly humiliating the international partners you represent.

Your other secret

You leaked the existence of the restitution talks to selected journalists to pressure Grant, even though the negotiations were supposed to remain confidential.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Find out whether Paige knows you were the leak.
3. Get Sue to acknowledge that the legal risk is real.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant threatened our confidential restitution negotiations. I was trying to get disputed objects returned without a public collapse of the talks. He preferred owning the objects to answering the letters.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I was at the Registrar's fax desk from 6:40 to 6:49, dealing with a confidential restitution packet. The museum attendant there watched me throughout. I did not go back to the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

From 6:40 to 6:49, I was at the Registrar's fax desk. I was dealing with a confidential restitution packet. I did not return to the Donor Salon during that time.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card A; animal CALLED = Card B. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The signed record confirms the attendant watched me at the Registrar's fax desk throughout the whole window. It also exposes a confidential restitution packet. I would rather be embarrassed than accused of murder.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

I stand by my account of being at the Registrar's fax desk. I dispute the service attendant's identification. I cannot produce a continuous alibi record. Please compare the time on that note with the poison window before deciding.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.

Elon Mosaic

Your grievance with Grant

Grant had blacklisted you from a major acquisition after you outbid him anonymously for a work he wanted. Tonight he planned to announce that your collecting practices were 'speculative theater' and block your appointment to the museum board.

Your other secret

You were the anonymous buyer in the auction incident everyone keeps referencing. You concealed your identity through Hugh to avoid a bidding war with Grant.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Keep Hugh from revealing your role in the auction.
3. Find out whether Artie supports your board candidacy.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant learned I had outbid him through a proxy. He threatened to expose me and wreck our deal. For once, someone had won an auction against him. He took it badly.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I was at the collection scanning desk from 6:40 to 6:49, dealing with the invoice identifying me as the anonymous bidder. The museum attendant there watched me throughout. I did not go back to the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

From 6:40 to 6:49, I was at the collection scanning desk. I was dealing with the invoice identifying me as the anonymous bidder. I did not return to the Donor Salon during that time.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card B; animal CALLED = Card A. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The signed record confirms the attendant watched me at the collection scanning desk throughout the whole window. It also exposes the invoice identifying me as the anonymous bidder. I would rather be embarrassed than accused of murder.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

I stand by my account of being at the collection scanning desk. I dispute the service attendant's identification. I cannot produce a continuous alibi record. Please compare the time on that note with the poison window before deciding.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.

Anya Tique

Your grievance with Grant

Grant planned to reveal that you accepted his first questionable donation in 1989 despite incomplete paperwork, staining the legacy you built.

Your other secret

You did approve that accession because the museum was desperate for funds and you convinced yourself the paperwork would follow.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Protect your private complication until you decide disclosure helps you.
3. Use your public relationships to trade information rather than waiting for clues to come to you.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant threatened to rewrite the museum's history around his own name. I helped found this place. I would prefer not to become a footnote to a man with a cheque book.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I stayed at the Grand Gallery bench from 6:40 to 6:49. An on-duty attendant checked my identity and watched me there the whole time. I did not enter the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

I stayed at the Grand Gallery bench from 6:40 to 6:49. An on-duty attendant checked my identity and watched me there the whole time. I did not enter the Donor Salon.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card A; animal CALLED = Card B. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The staff record confirms I stayed at the Grand Gallery bench for the whole window. It clears my whereabouts. It does not clear anyone else, and I cannot speak for what another guest did.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

The staff record confirms I stayed at the Grand Gallery bench for the whole window. It clears my whereabouts. It does not clear anyone else, and I cannot speak for what another guest did.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.

Saul D. Bid

Your grievance with Grant

Grant threatened to expose a private sale you arranged outside your auction house's normal process unless you waived a substantial fee.

Your other secret

You did route the sale through a discreet subsidiary to satisfy a client who insisted on anonymity.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Protect your private complication until you decide disclosure helps you.
3. Use your public relationships to trade information rather than waiting for clues to come to you.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant and I disagreed over an old sale. He knew something awkward about it and enjoyed reminding me. I wanted a settlement, preferably without an audience.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I stayed at the auction catalogue desk from 6:40 to 6:49. An on-duty attendant checked my identity and watched me there the whole time. I did not enter the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

I stayed at the auction catalogue desk from 6:40 to 6:49. An on-duty attendant checked my identity and watched me there the whole time. I did not enter the Donor Salon.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card B; animal CALLED = Card A. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The staff record confirms I stayed at the auction catalogue desk for the whole window. It clears my whereabouts. It does not clear anyone else, and I cannot speak for what another guest did.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

The staff record confirms I stayed at the auction catalogue desk for the whole window. It clears my whereabouts. It does not clear anyone else, and I cannot speak for what another guest did.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.

Elle Loominate

Your grievance with Grant

Grant intended to purchase a family-owned ceremonial textile you had borrowed for your installation, despite your refusal to sell.

Your other secret

The textile is in the exhibition without the full paperwork your family expected because you were afraid the loan would be denied.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Protect your private complication until you decide disclosure helps you.
3. Use your public relationships to trade information rather than waiting for clues to come to you.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant wanted my textile work treated as decoration rather than art. I objected. My work has survived centuries of tradition; it can survive a donor with no taste.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I stayed at the textile display from 6:40 to 6:49. An on-duty attendant checked my identity and watched me there the whole time. I did not enter the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

I stayed at the textile display from 6:40 to 6:49. An on-duty attendant checked my identity and watched me there the whole time. I did not enter the Donor Salon.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card A; animal CALLED = Card B. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The staff record confirms I stayed at the textile display for the whole window. It clears my whereabouts. It does not clear anyone else, and I cannot speak for what another guest did.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

The staff record confirms I stayed at the textile display for the whole window. It clears my whereabouts. It does not clear anyone else, and I cannot speak for what another guest did.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.

Reed DeLabel

Your grievance with Grant

You found an archival document that contradicted the Star Bowl label. Grant told your department your fellowship could disappear if you pushed it.

Your other secret

You have not yet told Art that your discovery also undermines one sentence in his published research.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Protect your private complication until you decide disclosure helps you.
3. Use your public relationships to trade information rather than waiting for clues to come to you.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant's decisions threatened my research and the disputed object label. I cared about getting the history right. That does not require killing the owner.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I stayed at the education workroom from 6:40 to 6:49. An on-duty attendant checked my identity and watched me there the whole time. I did not enter the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

I stayed at the education workroom from 6:40 to 6:49. An on-duty attendant checked my identity and watched me there the whole time. I did not enter the Donor Salon.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card B; animal CALLED = Card A. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The staff record confirms I stayed at the education workroom for the whole window. It clears my whereabouts. It does not clear anyone else, and I cannot speak for what another guest did.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

The staff record confirms I stayed at the education workroom for the whole window. It clears my whereabouts. It does not clear anyone else, and I cannot speak for what another guest did.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.

Al Baster

Your grievance with Grant

Grant planned to replace your commissioned entrance sculpture with a cheaper replica after the opening and dispute your final payment.

Your other secret

You built one internal support differently from the approved plan because the fabricator missed a deadline.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Protect your private complication until you decide disclosure helps you.
3. Use your public relationships to trade information rather than waiting for clues to come to you.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant meddled with the placement of my sculpture. I was angry enough to move a pedestal, which is inconvenient but legal.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I stayed at the sculpture preparation bay from 6:40 to 6:49.
An on-duty attendant checked my identity and watched me there the whole time. I did not enter the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

I stayed at the sculpture preparation bay from 6:40 to 6:49.
An on-duty attendant checked my identity and watched me there the whole time. I did not enter the Donor Salon.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card A; animal CALLED = Card B. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The staff record confirms I stayed at the sculpture preparation bay for the whole window. It clears my whereabouts. It does not clear anyone else, and I cannot speak for what another guest did.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

The staff record confirms I stayed at the sculpture preparation bay for the whole window. It clears my whereabouts. It does not clear anyone else, and I cannot speak for what another guest did.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.

Ella Gance

Your grievance with Grant

Grant knew you quietly sold a work you had publicly promised to donate to another institution and planned to expose the contradiction.

Your other secret

You sold it to cover a failed business investment and hoped to replace it before anyone noticed.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Protect your private complication until you decide disclosure helps you.
3. Use your public relationships to trade information rather than waiting for clues to come to you.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant had strong opinions about my purchases and influence. I had equally strong opinions about his. We were not planning to exchange compliments tonight.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I stayed at the coat-check lounge from 6:40 to 6:49. An on-duty attendant checked my identity and watched me there the whole time. I did not enter the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

I stayed at the coat-check lounge from 6:40 to 6:49. An on-duty attendant checked my identity and watched me there the whole time. I did not enter the Donor Salon.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card B; animal CALLED = Card A. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The staff record confirms I stayed at the coat-check lounge for the whole window. It clears my whereabouts. It does not clear anyone else, and I cannot speak for what another guest did.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

The staff record confirms I stayed at the coat-check lounge for the whole window. It clears my whereabouts. It does not clear anyone else, and I cannot speak for what another guest did.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.

Drew Conclusions

Your grievance with Grant

Grant discovered that you write an anonymous satirical newsletter skewering museum patrons and planned to unmask you during his speech.

Your other secret

Several jokes in the newsletter came from private conversations, and you regret at least one of them.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Protect your private complication until you decide disclosure helps you.
3. Use your public relationships to trade information rather than waiting for clues to come to you.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant wanted favourable coverage. I wanted to criticize the exhibition. A living donor can demand a correction; a dead one cannot answer a follow-up.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I stayed at the podcast recording booth from 6:40 to 6:49. An on-duty attendant checked my identity and watched me there the whole time. I did not enter the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

I stayed at the podcast recording booth from 6:40 to 6:49. An on-duty attendant checked my identity and watched me there the whole time. I did not enter the Donor Salon.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card A; animal CALLED = Card B. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The staff record confirms I stayed at the podcast recording booth for the whole window. It clears my whereabouts. It does not clear anyone else, and I cannot speak for what another guest did.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

The staff record confirms I stayed at the podcast recording booth for the whole window. It clears my whereabouts. It does not clear anyone else, and I cannot speak for what another guest did.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.

Brie DeVivre

Your grievance with Grant

Grant had refused to approve the final catering invoice and planned to blame you for a last-minute service change he personally ordered.

Your other secret

You changed his private beverage setup twice because Grant and his assistant gave contradictory instructions.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Protect your private complication until you decide disclosure helps you.
3. Use your public relationships to trade information rather than waiting for clues to come to you.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant's private drink service disrupted my kitchen. I served the gala food, not poison. His cordial had a separate tray and his own instructions.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I stayed at the buffet kitchen from 6:40 to 6:49. An on-duty attendant checked my identity and watched me there the whole time. I did not enter the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

I stayed at the buffet kitchen from 6:40 to 6:49. An on-duty attendant checked my identity and watched me there the whole time. I did not enter the Donor Salon.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card B; animal CALLED = Card A. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The staff record confirms I stayed at the buffet kitchen for the whole window. It clears my whereabouts. It does not clear anyone else, and I cannot speak for what another guest did.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

The staff record confirms I stayed at the buffet kitchen for the whole window. It clears my whereabouts. It does not clear anyone else, and I cannot speak for what another guest did.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.

Cary Crates

Your grievance with Grant

Grant saw you damage a minor frame during installation and threatened to have you fired after the gala, despite the damage being repairable.

Your other secret

You concealed the crack with a reversible mount until Chip could inspect it after opening night.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Protect your private complication until you decide disclosure helps you.
3. Use your public relationships to trade information rather than waiting for clues to come to you.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant's shipment paperwork looked familiar for bad reasons. I wanted the crate history checked. I handle objects; I do not manufacture their ownership history.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I stayed at the loading-bay worktable from 6:40 to 6:49. An on-duty attendant checked my identity and watched me there the whole time. I did not enter the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

I stayed at the loading-bay worktable from 6:40 to 6:49. An on-duty attendant checked my identity and watched me there the whole time. I did not enter the Donor Salon.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card A; animal CALLED = Card B. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The staff record confirms I stayed at the loading-bay worktable for the whole window. It clears my whereabouts. It does not clear anyone else, and I cannot speak for what another guest did.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

The staff record confirms I stayed at the loading-bay worktable for the whole window. It clears my whereabouts. It does not clear anyone else, and I cannot speak for what another guest did.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.

Anne E. Dote

Your grievance with Grant

Grant's gift conditions would cut public education programming to fund a private donor lounge and VIP entrance.

Your other secret

You organized an anonymous staff petition against the plan and slipped copies into trustee folders.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Protect your private complication until you decide disclosure helps you.
3. Use your public relationships to trade information rather than waiting for clues to come to you.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant's budget cut the school programmes for a VIP entrance. I wanted those funds restored. Children need a museum more than a billionaire needs another door.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I stayed at the school-tour display from 6:40 to 6:49. An on-duty attendant checked my identity and watched me there the whole time. I did not enter the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

I stayed at the school-tour display from 6:40 to 6:49. An on-duty attendant checked my identity and watched me there the whole time. I did not enter the Donor Salon.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card B; animal CALLED = Card A. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The staff record confirms I stayed at the school-tour display for the whole window. It clears my whereabouts. It does not clear anyone else, and I cannot speak for what another guest did.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

The staff record confirms I stayed at the school-tour display for the whole window. It clears my whereabouts. It does not clear anyone else, and I cannot speak for what another guest did.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.

Faye Stop

Your grievance with Grant

Grant ordered you to surrender a photograph showing him meeting privately with Hugh beside a shell-company shipping file.

Your other secret

You kept a backup print after agreeing to delete the image from your camera.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Protect your private complication until you decide disclosure helps you.
3. Use your public relationships to trade information rather than waiting for clues to come to you.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant wanted control of which gala photographs could be published. I wanted my actual work seen. I was busy taking it.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I stayed at the portrait backdrop from 6:40 to 6:49. An on-duty attendant checked my identity and watched me there the whole time. I did not enter the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

I stayed at the portrait backdrop from 6:40 to 6:49. An on-duty attendant checked my identity and watched me there the whole time. I did not enter the Donor Salon.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card A; animal CALLED = Card B. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The staff record confirms I stayed at the portrait backdrop for the whole window. It clears my whereabouts. It does not clear anyone else, and I cannot speak for what another guest did.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

The staff record confirms I stayed at the portrait backdrop for the whole window. It clears my whereabouts. It does not clear anyone else, and I cannot speak for what another guest did.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.

Robin Banks

Your grievance with Grant

Grant had you removed from a previous museum event and threatened legal action if you disrupted tonight's unveiling.

Your other secret

You planted small 'PROVENANCE IS A VERB' stickers in several gallery brochures for a peaceful protest.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Protect your private complication until you decide disclosure helps you.
3. Use your public relationships to trade information rather than waiting for clues to come to you.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant refused to take restitution seriously. I brought a petition and argued for returns. I wanted public pressure, not a private poisoning.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I stayed at the guest petition desk from 6:40 to 6:49. An on-duty attendant checked my identity and watched me there the whole time. I did not enter the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

I stayed at the guest petition desk from 6:40 to 6:49. An on-duty attendant checked my identity and watched me there the whole time. I did not enter the Donor Salon.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card B; animal CALLED = Card A. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The staff record confirms I stayed at the guest petition desk for the whole window. It clears my whereabouts. It does not clear anyone else, and I cannot speak for what another guest did.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

The staff record confirms I stayed at the guest petition desk for the whole window. It clears my whereabouts. It does not clear anyone else, and I cannot speak for what another guest did.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.

Penny Pincher

Your grievance with Grant

One decorative object in the exhibition once belonged to your family. You believe Grant acquired it through a manipulative private sale decades ago.

Your other secret

You brought old correspondence proving your family contested that sale and planned to confront him tonight.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Protect your private complication until you decide disclosure helps you.
3. Use your public relationships to trade information rather than waiting for clues to come to you.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant and I had unfinished business over an old purchase. I wanted the story cleared up. I do collect eccentric objects, but not criminal charges.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I stayed at the collector lounge from 6:40 to 6:49. An on-duty attendant checked my identity and watched me there the whole time. I did not enter the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

I stayed at the collector lounge from 6:40 to 6:49. An on-duty attendant checked my identity and watched me there the whole time. I did not enter the Donor Salon.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card A; animal CALLED = Card B. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The staff record confirms I stayed at the collector lounge for the whole window. It clears my whereabouts. It does not clear anyone else, and I cannot speak for what another guest did.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

The staff record confirms I stayed at the collector lounge for the whole window. It clears my whereabouts. It does not clear anyone else, and I cannot speak for what another guest did.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.

Justin Tyme

Your grievance with Grant

Grant fed you several flattering claims for an earlier profile that you later discovered were exaggerated. He threatened to cut off access if you corrected them.

Your other secret

You are preparing a correction that will also make you look embarrassingly credulous.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Protect your private complication until you decide disclosure helps you.
3. Use your public relationships to trade information rather than waiting for clues to come to you.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant preferred a flattering version of local history. I had evidence of the less flattering version. I intended to write about it.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I stayed at the local-history display from 6:40 to 6:49. An on-duty attendant checked my identity and watched me there the whole time. I did not enter the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

I stayed at the local-history display from 6:40 to 6:49. An on-duty attendant checked my identity and watched me there the whole time. I did not enter the Donor Salon.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card B; animal CALLED = Card A. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The staff record confirms I stayed at the local-history display for the whole window. It clears my whereabouts. It does not clear anyone else, and I cannot speak for what another guest did.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

The staff record confirms I stayed at the local-history display for the whole window. It clears my whereabouts. It does not clear anyone else, and I cannot speak for what another guest did.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.

Minnie Malist

Your grievance with Grant

Grant ordered you to add a gaudy lighting cue to the unveiling and threatened to withhold payment when Frank objected.

Your other secret

You secretly changed the cue again after approval, causing the eerie light flickers guests noticed during Act I.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Protect your private complication until you decide disclosure helps you.
3. Use your public relationships to trade information rather than waiting for clues to come to you.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant changed the gala lighting and credits after approval. I wanted my work credited properly. A dramatic reveal is not supposed to include a corpse.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I stayed at the event-control desk from 6:40 to 6:49. An on-duty attendant checked my identity and watched me there the whole time. I did not enter the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

I stayed at the event-control desk from 6:40 to 6:49. An on-duty attendant checked my identity and watched me there the whole time. I did not enter the Donor Salon.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card A; animal CALLED = Card B. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The staff record confirms I stayed at the event-control desk for the whole window. It clears my whereabouts. It does not clear anyone else, and I cannot speak for what another guest did.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

The staff record confirms I stayed at the event-control desk for the whole window. It clears my whereabouts. It does not clear anyone else, and I cannot speak for what another guest did.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.